MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps & Platform Engineering | QA Automation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Infrastructure-focused QA Automation Engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines and test infrastructure for three product teams. Improved pipeline speed and reliability, and built short-lived Kubernetes test environments using Helm and GitLab CI. Brings additional personal experience with k3s, GitOps, monitoring and Terraform-based VPS provisioning. Transitioning toward a full-time DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm

Infrastructure and platforms: Kubernetes (Helm workloads with namespace-level access; personal k3s cluster), Terraform (personal project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic), Linux

Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Programming and testing: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw
2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, plus artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Built a flaky-test dashboard using CI results, PostgreSQL and Grafana to help teams identify and address recurring failures.
- Wrote an internal guide to the CI system used in team onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git

repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Delivered short-lived environments for merge requests, deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review changes before merge and run end-to-end tests against seeded environments.
- Automated environment removal after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam scheduled for January 2027; currently studying

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)